



Pricelist

Headsets (regular)	100 - 500
Headsets (Bluetooth)	2,800 - 6,000
Bluetooth Enabled phones	7,500 - 40,000
USB/IR adapters	From 1,000/500
Chargers	100 - 500
Nokia Medallion	8,000
Digital Pen	12,000

Apart from hiding your phone, hands-free kits will liberate you from the chore of pulling your phone out of your pocket every two minutes and 15 seconds to answer a call or view an SMS. Just set the phone to auto-answer, and plug in your hands-free! Be careful

though—you will need to get used to people looking at you strangely for walking about talking to yourself!

So what's available? A standard made-in-an-Indian-back-alley wired hands-free for as little as Rs 100, the real deal for Rs 400 or more, and futuristic-looking Bluetooth headsets that start at Rs 2,800 (grey market). Good Bluetooth headsets are really tiny, have a range of about 30 feet, and cost anywhere from Rs 4,750 to Rs 6,000. Check the talk and standby time of the cheaper models.

Jabra has released its BT800 Bluetooth hands-free, which has an LCD screen that lets you access last-dialled and recently-called numbers, send or read SMSes and access your phone's voice tags—remember, you still can't access your phone's menu or your contact list!

Even if you are one of the unfortunate few stuck with a phone without Bluetooth, there are adapters available that set your phone free of wires. Nokia retails theirs for Rs 2,300, and it works with almost their entire range of colour-screen phones.

More, More...

Another type of hands-free that is available is radio hands-free. This headset has radio integrated—you can hum your way through the chores of the day! An original Nokia radio headset is priced at around Rs 1,800. Local-made radio hands-free sets are available for as little as Rs 100, and their clarity is decent enough.

For MMS-enabled phones, Nokia has released a headset with an integrated camera that retails for about Rs 3,450. Now you can snap pictures and share them via MMS. This will make your phone look really cool and you, tech savvy—though the ladies might avoid you like the plague!

Speaking of public broadcasting, who says your hands-free kit and phone conversations need to be personal? Get Bluetooth-enabled hands-free speaker sets with inbuilt batteries. Now, people can hear both you and your caller yelling over the phone while travelling in crowded buses.



What is Bluetooth?

Bluetooth is a short-range communications standard for wireless data communications. It works in the 2.45 GHz band, and allows various devices to connect wirelessly. Bluetooth technology was conceived by Ericsson, but founded and developed by Ericsson, Nokia, IBM, Intel and Toshiba.

The current Bluetooth technology provides for data transfer at a rate of 1 Mbps, with a personal area range of up to 10m-client-to-client and open air, and 5 m when in a building. For client-to-access point connections, the current range is 100 m in open air and 30 m in buildings.

Unlike Infra Red, Bluetooth does not require line of sight, as long as you stay within the range you will remain connected. Setting up Bluetooth is easy, just switch on both devices and let them find each other. Now all you have to do is enter a common pass key and you can start exchanging data.

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